

Story Mapping

the big picture...

Story Mapping

Story mapping keeps us focused on users and their experience, and the result is a better conversation, and ultimately a better product.



User Story Traps

- Focus on building small things
- When will we be done
- Stories are like conversations - people avoid writing anything
- Focus on acceptance criteria.
- Because good stories are supposed to be written from a user's perspective, and there are lots of parts that users never see, team members argue that "our product doesn't have users, so user stories won't work here."

Telephone game

- People interpret instructions differently



Cake Wrecks



Customer: He

Employee: Su

Customer: Co

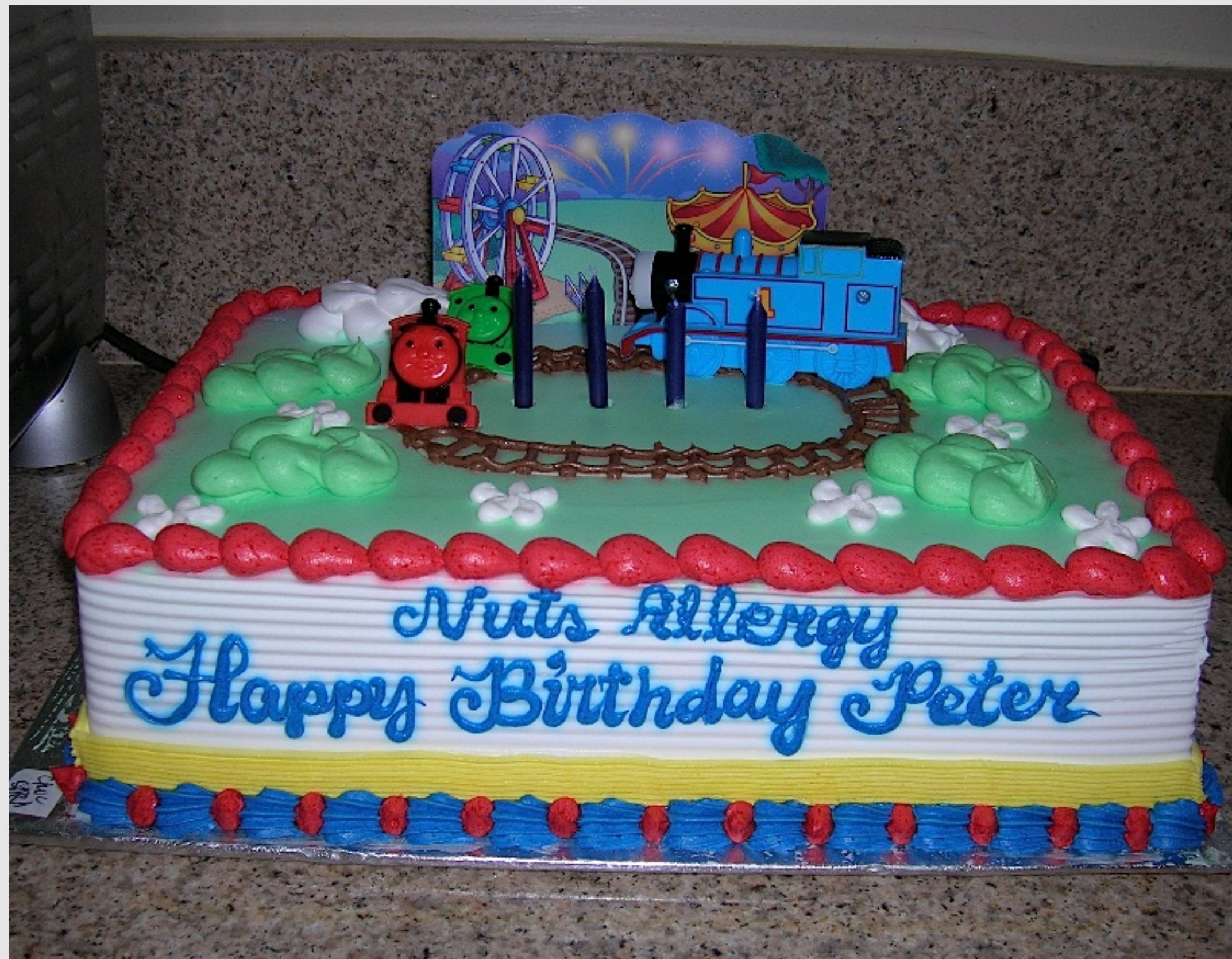
Employee: Su

Customer: An

Employee: No

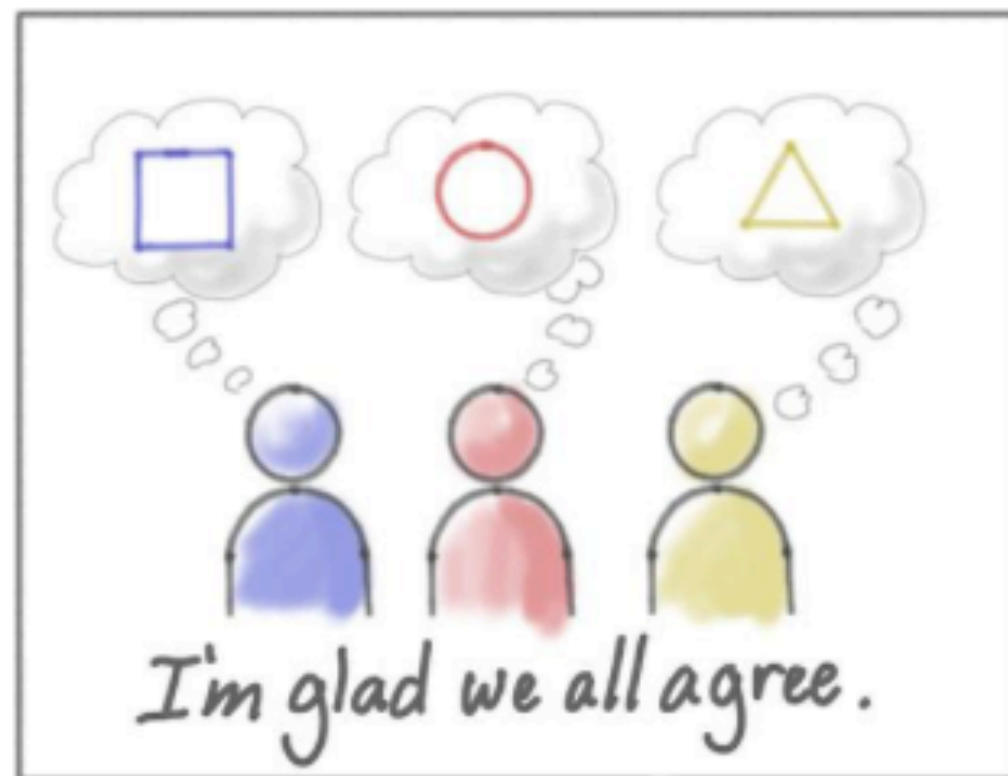
We'll have it fo

Cake Wrecks



“Shared documents aren’t shared understanding”

Building shared understanding



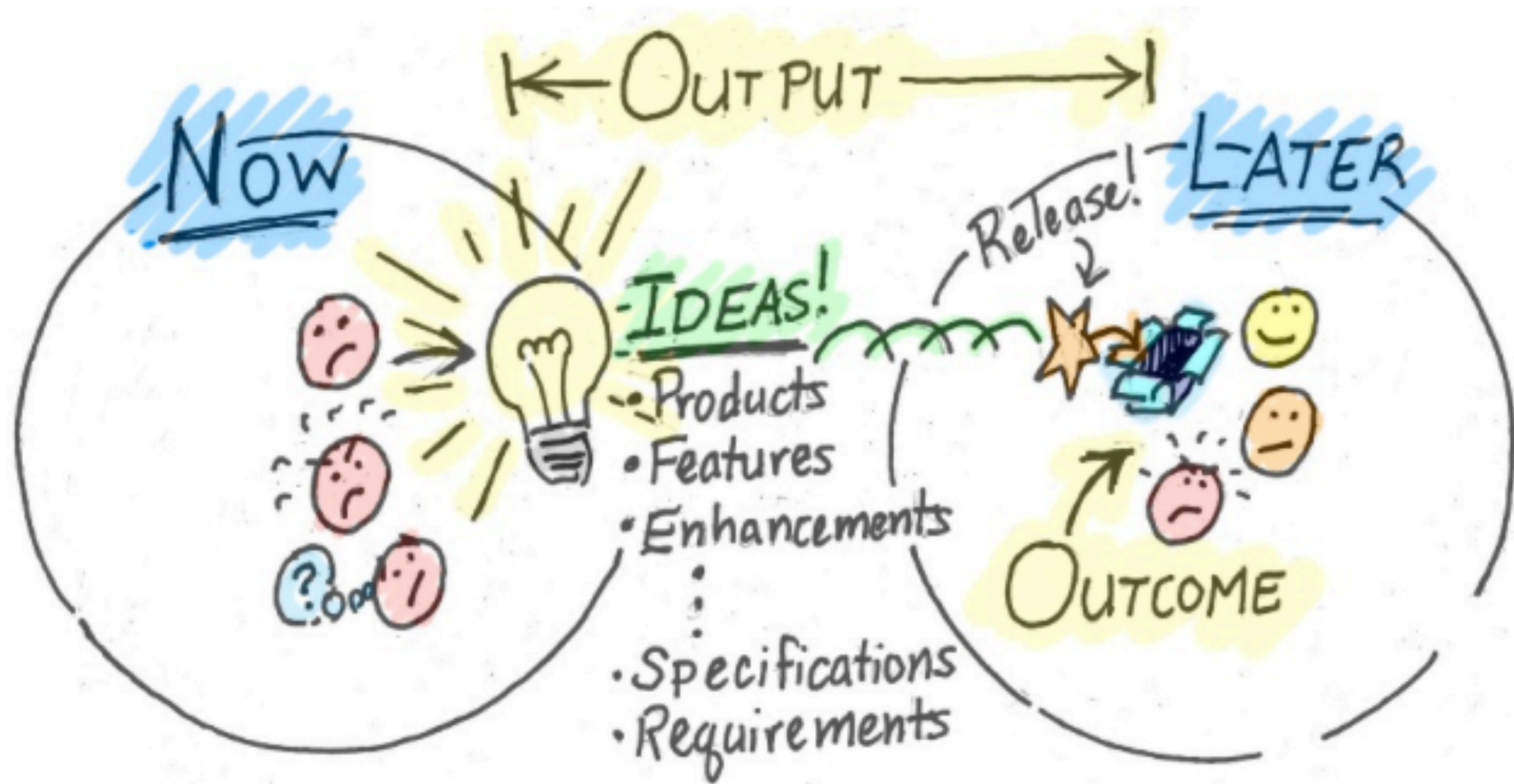
The real goal of user stories is shared understanding

Good stories are like vaccination photos



Good stories are like vaccination photos





Minimize This ↓

← OUTPUT →

Now

LATER

IDEAS!

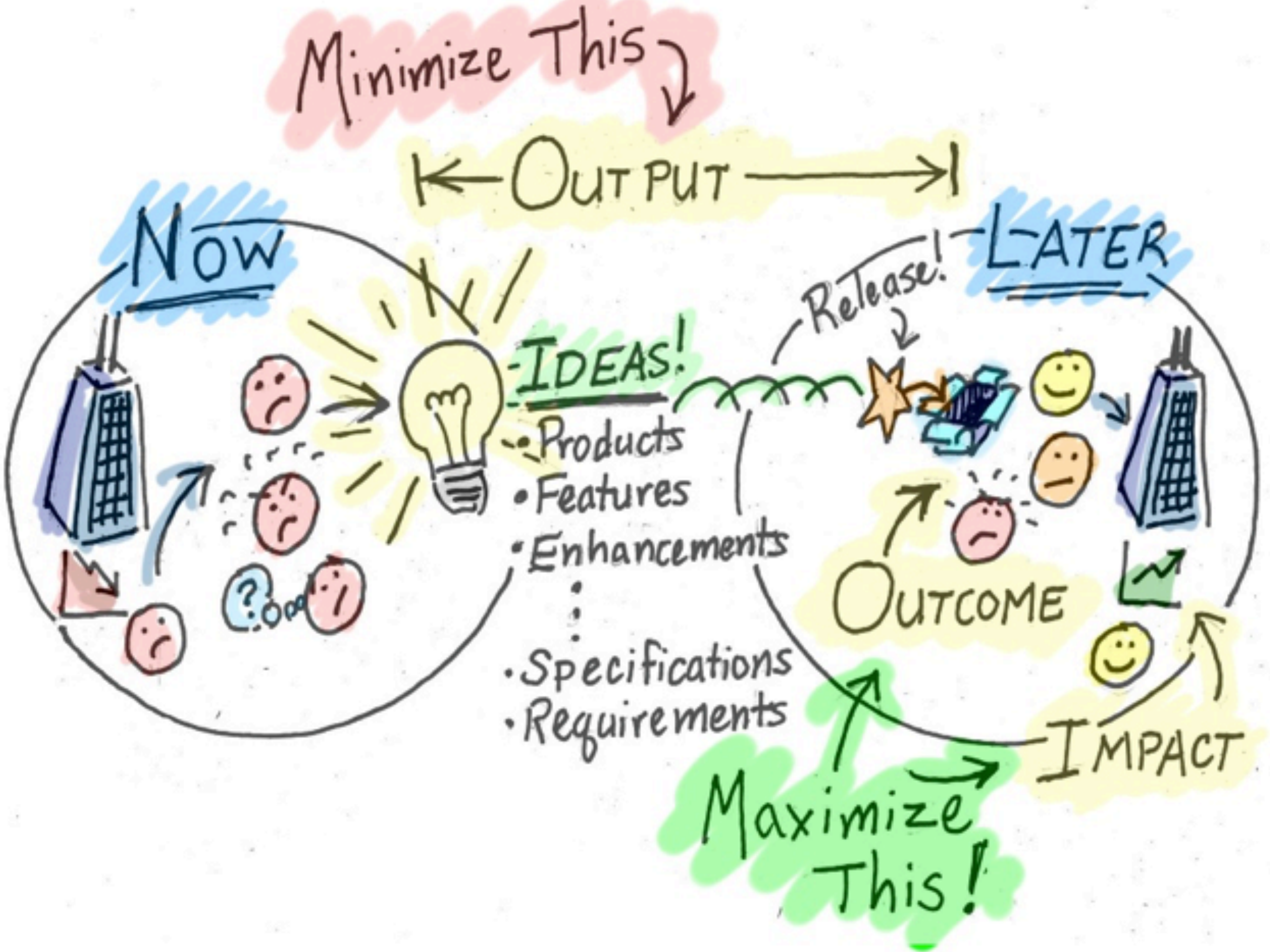
- Products
- Features
- Enhancements
- Specifications
- Requirements

Release!

OUTCOME

IMPACT

Maximize This!



Story Mapping

- Think big, act small
- Talk and doc
 - write cards with key points



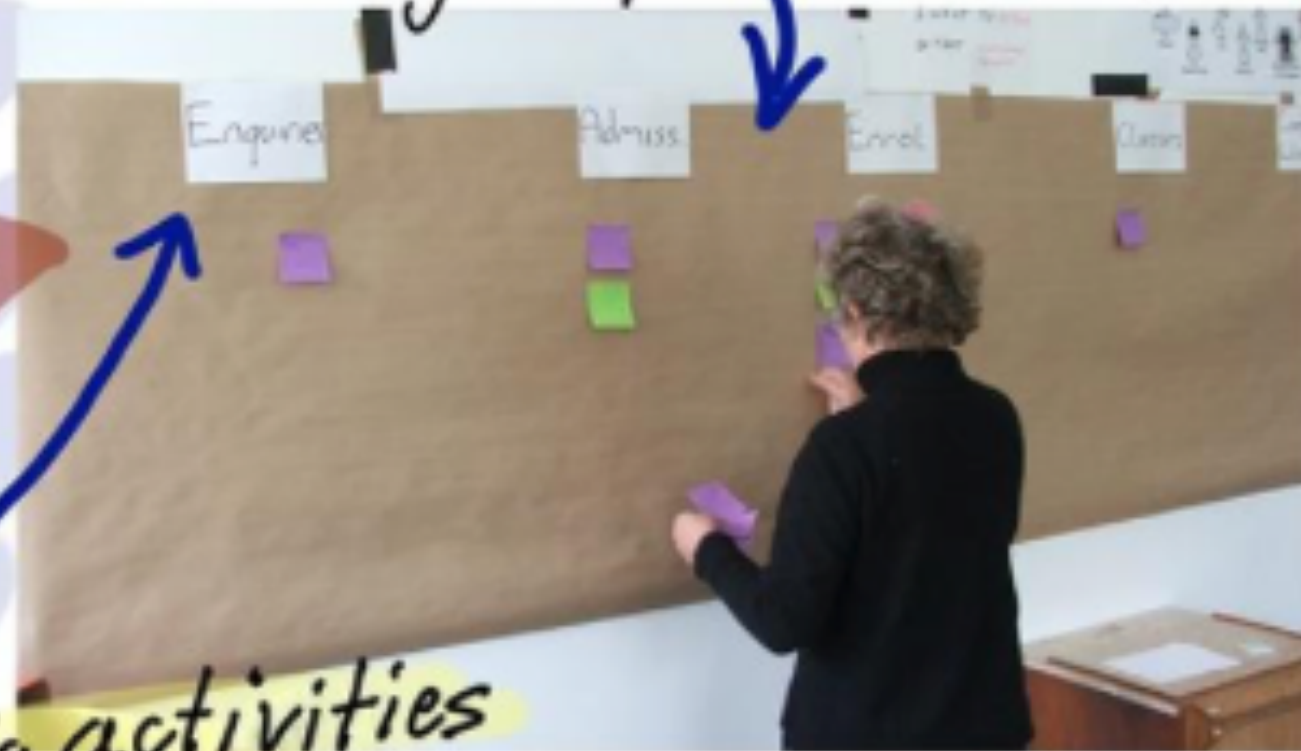
Marty Cagan

The BACKBONE

as a simple
process diagram



as the skeleton of
a story map



the same big activities

The map loaded with ideas

printed ideas we identified before the workshop

new ideas added during the workshop on sticky-notes



Talking through each activity

Is it complete?
Does it make sense?



Prioritizing

the sponsor



↑ in

↓ out

the product owner



the "line"

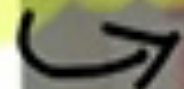
↑ in

↓ out

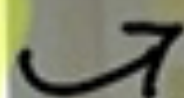
they work together!



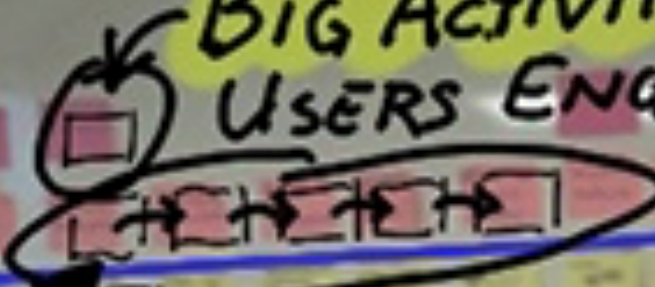
BACKBONE



BODY



BIG Activity
USERS ENGAGE IN



STEPS THAT HAPPEN
IN THAT ACTIVITY

DETAILS
IN THE
STEP ABOVE

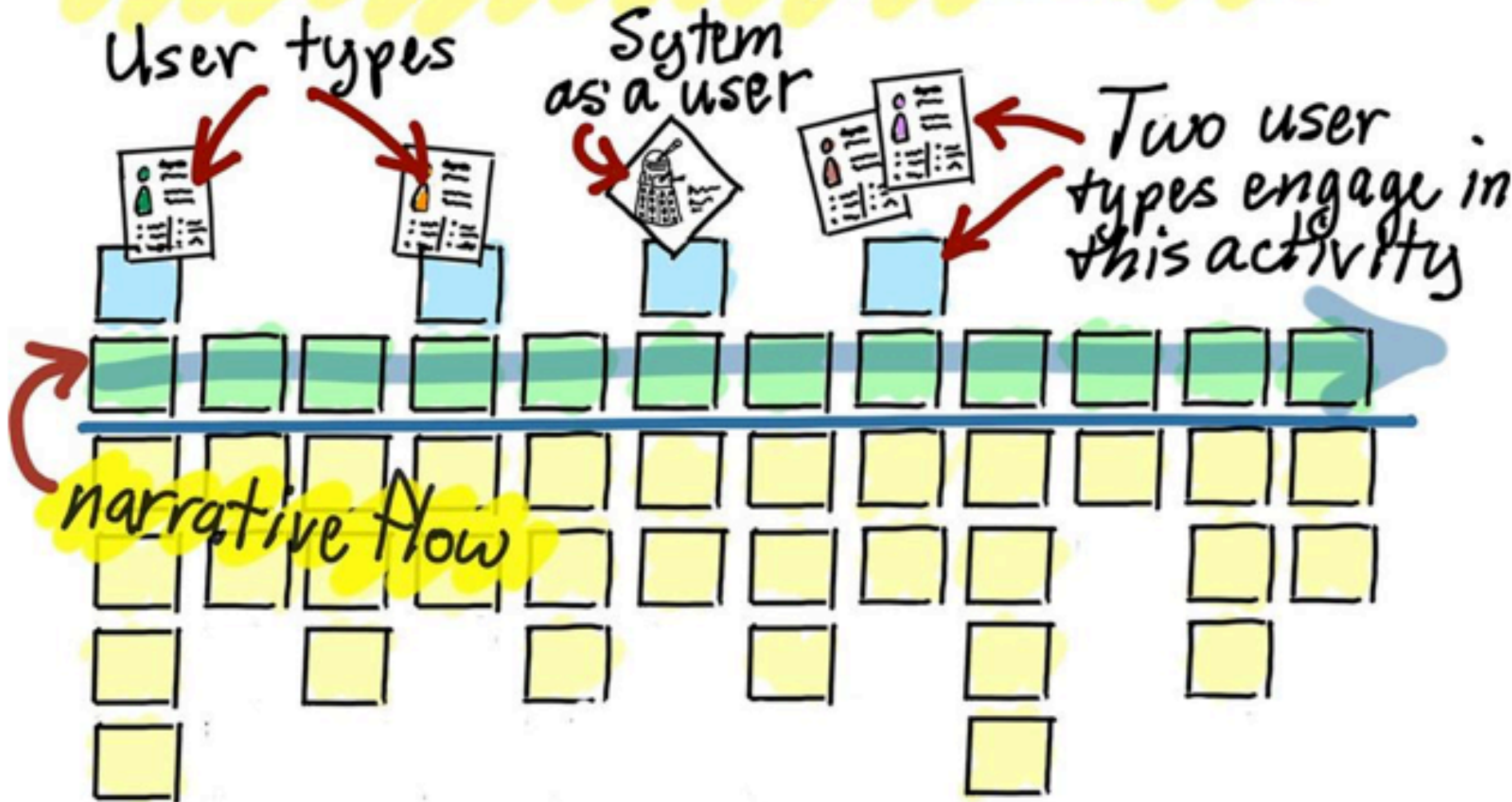


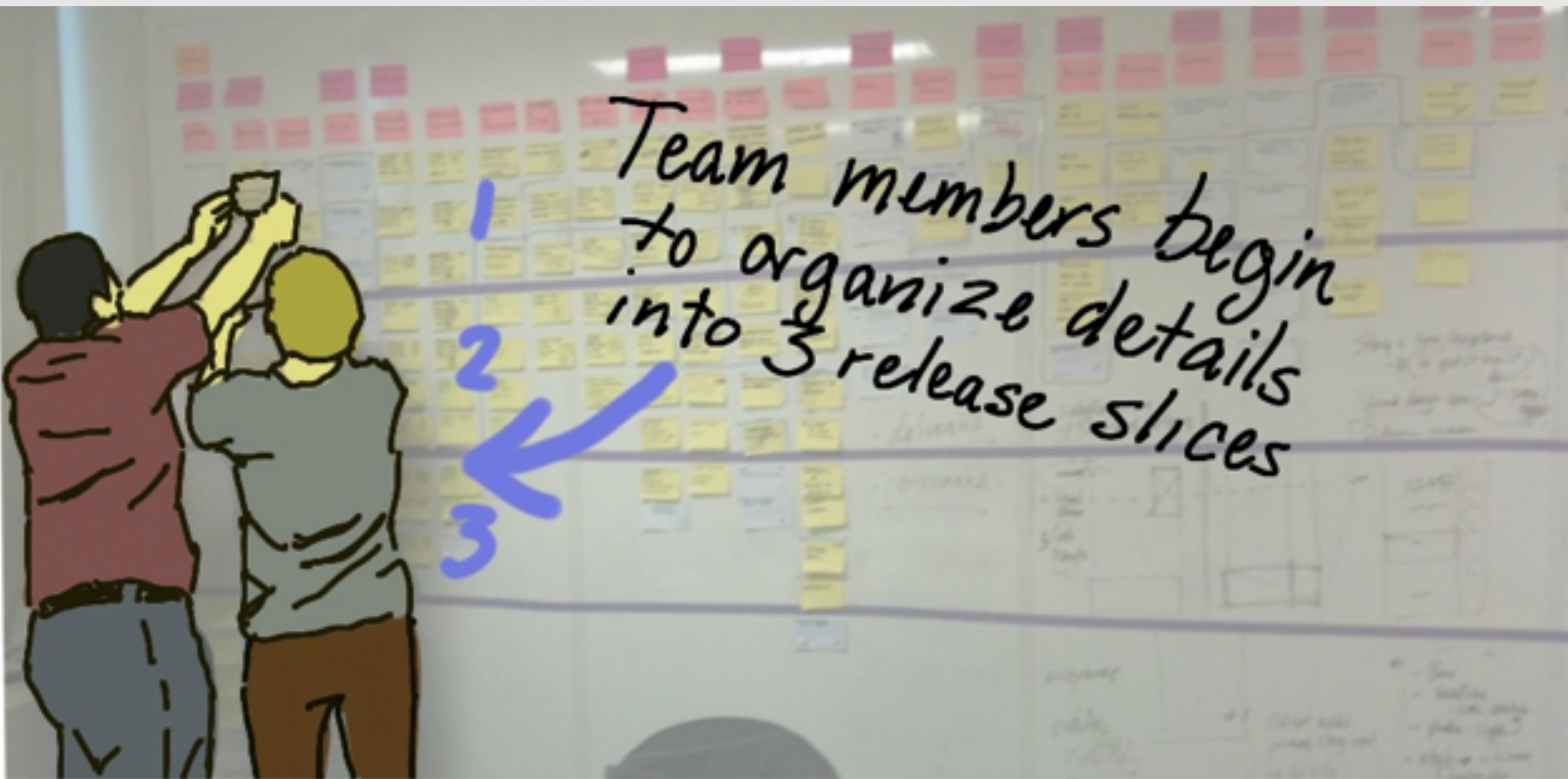
This map crosses many types of users

User types

System
as a user

Two user
types engage in
this activity





Team members begin
to organize details
into 3 release slices

1
2
3



Target
Outcomes

Viable Releases
(at least we think
they are...)

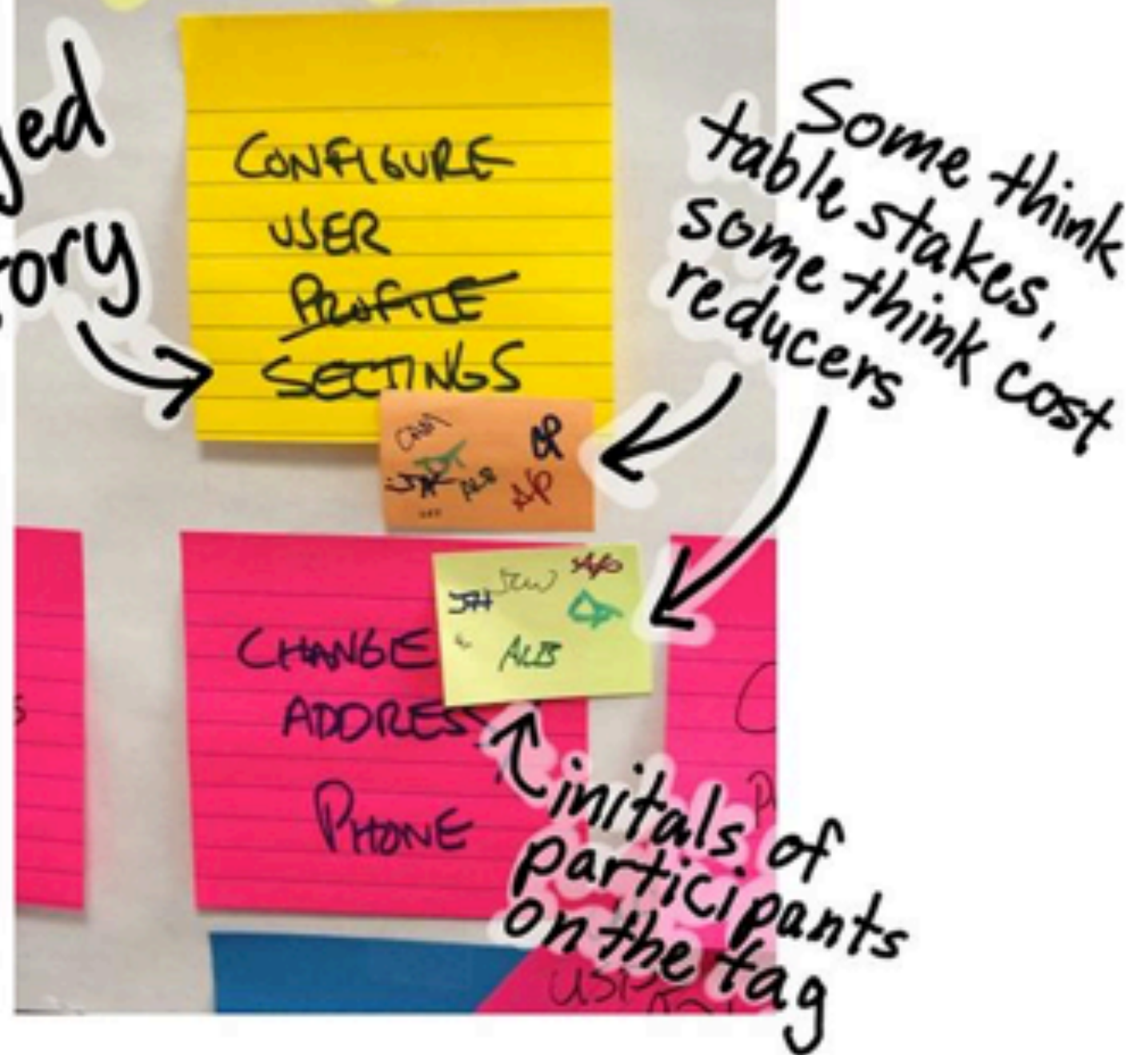
All the rest

Tag stories with different types

Tags



Tagged story



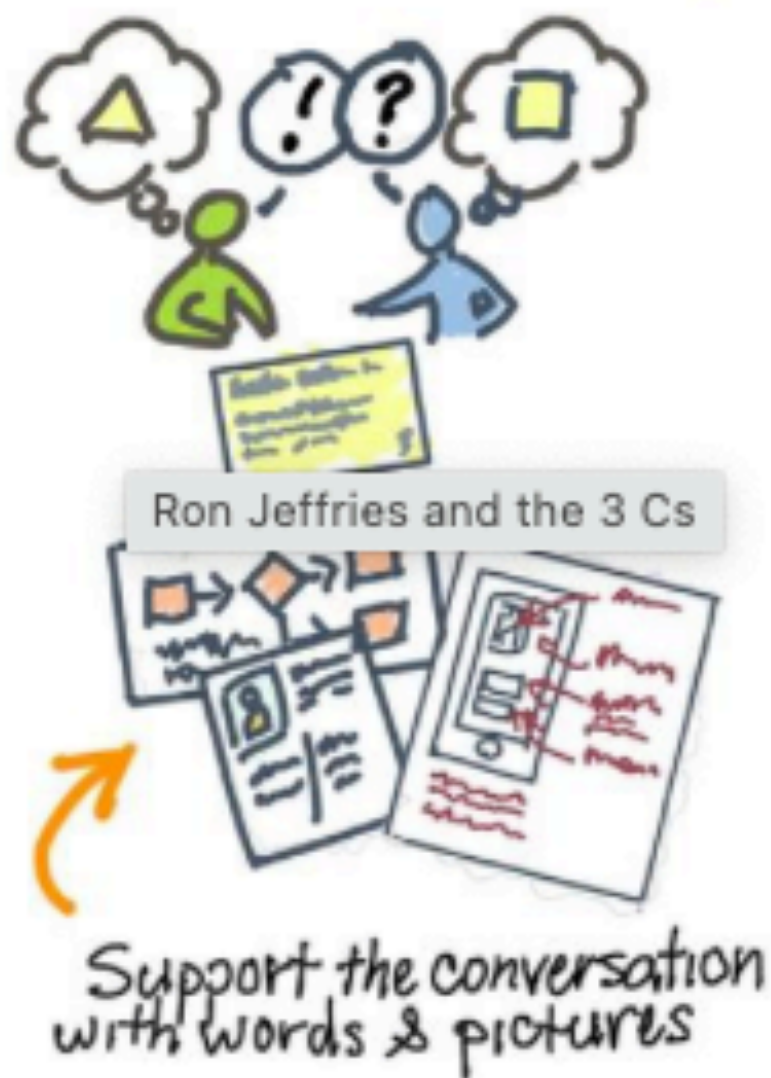
CARD



CONVERSATION



CONFIRMATION



Tracking System Ticket Number

DR-141

Short Title

Ask a question while reviewing

Importance
Indicated with
a colored dot

in
discovery

Status
Tagged with
a sticky note

Description
includes target
user, their task,
and goal

who: document reviewers reviewing quarterly
reports to board of directors
what: ask a question about specific information
in the report
ask it electronically as I review
why: I need to be confident the information
is accurate before I sign off - give my approval

Related Stories

related: answering questions
reviewing open questions
reviewing answered questions
notifying question asker when there's a response

Author

Jeff

17-Jan-2013

Date Created

Rough size

Radiators and Ice Boxes